



Saline lake

Salt slabs are extracted from Lake Assal, the world's largest salt reserve. At 508 ft (155 m) below sea level, it is the lowest point in Africa.

Camel caravans

Groups of camels are used to transport heavy loads to markets for sale.



0 50 km
0 50 miles
(approximate scale)



Djibouti



Whale sharks

Djibouti's coral reefs are the habitat of whale sharks. Scuba diving with the huge, harmless sharks is a popular tourist attraction.



The small country of Djibouti has a wild landscape of **coral reefs, volcanoes, and salt lakes**. Most of the population lives in the nation's **coastal capital, Djibouti**. This growing **port city** is located on one of the world's busiest **shipping routes**.

- 8,958 sq miles (23,200 sq km)
- 921,800
- Djibouti
- Somali, Afar, French, Arabic



Trading port

Somalia's capital Mogadishu is a port city on the Indian Ocean. It is one of Africa's most densely populated urban areas.

Somalia



- 246,200 sq miles (637,657 sq km)
- 11.8 million
- Mogadishu
- Somali, Arabic, English, Italian

Somalia runs along the **eastern coast** of the **Horn of Africa**. The landscape is hot and dry. Some believe this country was once the **fabled Land of Punt**, an ancient kingdom where goods such as **gold, myrrh, and frankincense** were traded.

0 200 km
0 200 miles
(approximate scale)



Wooden headrest

Somali nomads use headrests for sleeping. These are carved out of wood and painted with intricate patterns.

Traditional dance

Dhaanto is a traditional dance performed to local music by groups of Somalis.

